

Working together

Finding nectar, the sugary liquid inside flowers, is hard work. It can take a lot of flying to find the perfect patch of flowers. When honeybees find a particularly good source of nectar and pollen, they tell the rest of the colony exactly where to find it.

A colony is a group of insects that live together.

Foxglove flowers have nectar guides.



Honeybee



Bumblebee

Pollen basket

Finding food

Some flowers have special patterns on their petals called nectar guides. Bees use their excellent eyesight to follow these guides and discover the hidden nectar.

Carrying the goods

A bee has a special stomach for carrying nectar back to the hive. Some bees also have pollen baskets on their back legs to collect and transport pollen.

